

Brazil's Road Back

International Tourism Recovery 2015–2024

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IronHack Data Analytics Bootcamp | Final Project | May 2026



Viewpoint
INSIGHTS

Turning data into direction.

Why This Project?

Personal Connection

- Bachelors in Tourism, with emphasis in Tourism development
- Believe tourism is one of the most powerful tools for building a less prejudiced, more connected world
- Experienced COVID from both Germany and Brazil, and saw firsthand how differently two countries can respond to the same crisis
- Brazil still has enormous untapped. This project is my attempt to show that through data

Analytical Opportunity

- Built entirely on official government data: Ministério do Turismo and UN Tourism
- Touches on most of what we covered during the bootcamp: data cleaning and wrangling, EDA, visualization and app development
- Global benchmarking puts Brazil's recovery in perspective against 220+ countries
- A strong portfolio piece that combines technical skills with a topic I genuinely care about

The Data

Ministério do Turismo (Brazil)

- 10 separate yearly CSVs (2015–2024)
- Cleaned & merged into one dataset
- 439,438 rows, monthly granularity
- Country of origin, entry route, state
- COVID period & season flags added

UN Tourism (UNWTO)

- 200+ countries, annual data (1995–2024)
- Overnight tourists & same-day visitors
- Verified against Brazil's official entry records: totals are consistent between both sources
- Global context: Brazil vs world

Data Limitations & Bias

01

Pre-aggregation — Brazilian states

The Ministério do Turismo aggregates less common state entries into 'Outras Unidades da Federação'. Only top states are visible individually — granular state-level analysis is limited.

02

Annual data only — UNWTO

The UN Tourism database provides yearly totals only. Monthly and seasonal fluctuation analysis is only possible with the Brazilian dataset.

03

Voluntary reporting — UNWTO

Countries self-report to the UN. Missing reports can bias global comparisons and rankings.

04

Unequal period lengths in COVID comparison

Pre-COVID label covers 5 years of data (2015–2019), and Post Covid covers only 3 years. However, we can do yearly analysis via filters in the Brazil dashboard.

Business Questions

- 01 How does Brazil's recovery compare to the global average?
- 02 How did total arrivals collapse in 2020-2021 and recover through 2024? Are we back to 2019 levels?
- 03 Which countries sent the most tourists to Brazil pre-COVID vs post-COVID?
- 04 Has the balance between air, land, sea and river entries changed since COVID?
- 05 How can Brazil improve destination visibility during its tourism recovery?**

The Analysis

Tableau Dashboards

Two interactive dashboards — live demo below.

World Panorama

Global arrivals, continent breakdown, Brazil vs world ranking

Brazil Deep Dive

Recovery timeline, who visits, entry routes, seasonality, state map

[Live Demo](#)

Key Insights

Brazil is back: 2024 surpasses the 2018 peak

With 2018 as the baseline with 6.6M arrivals, Brazil has fully recovered. In 2024 the country welcomed 6.8M international tourists, surpassing the pre-COVID peak for the first time.

Neighbours and visa-free allies lead the way

Argentina accounts for roughly 1 in 3 arrivals. Between 2022 and 2024, every single country in the top 10 had visa-free access to Brazil.

Summer is king, but every season matters

40% of arrivals happen in summer, driven by Carnival, Réveillon and beach season. The remaining seasons share the rest in a surprisingly balanced split.

Air and Land dominates, but the mix has shifted

Air entries have fully recovered and lead the rebound. Sea and river entries swapped positions post-COVID, signaling a shift in how visitors arrive.

Brazil Travel Recommender App

An interactive Streamlit app that recommends Brazilian destinations based on user travel preferences.

When to travel

Month — January to December

Experience type

Nature, beach, culture, adventure, city

Crowd preference

Love the buzz vs prefer quiet

Weather preference

Hot, warm, mild, cool

What the app returns

- Destination name, state and image
- Best and good months to visit
- Weather and crowd level profile
- Why this month is great for this place
- Brief description and highlights
- Link to explore more on visitbrasil.com

[Live Demo](#)

Next Steps

Future Analysis

Gather 2025 & 2026 data to enable a true balanced comparison:

Pre-COVID

2015–2019
5 years

Post-COVID

2022–2026
5 years

Currently only 3 post-COVID years available. Adding 2025–2026 data would create a symmetrical 5-year vs 5-year comparison for a more reliable recovery analysis.

Travel Recommender App — Future Development

Annual data updates

Update best months and good months as tourism patterns evolve.

Expand destination database

Currently 51 destinations. Idea is to grow it to cover more municipalities and hidden gems across all states.

Add event calendar

Integrate a real-time events calendar so recommendations reflect upcoming festivals and local events that might not be a driven on themselves

Multi-destination trips

Allow users to plan itineraries with multiple destinations, optimised by geography and travel time.

Smarter recommendations

Explore more personalised approaches beyond rule-based filtering.

Thank You

Brazil is back, and the data proves it.

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github.com/craftedbygaby | IronHack Data Analytics Bootcamp | May 2026



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